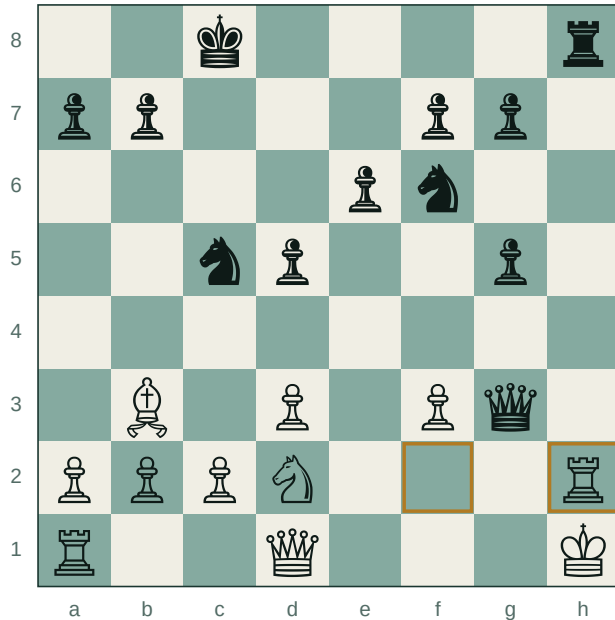


Mate in one: Black, move 20

Mate in one

Black to move



Previous move: 20.Rh2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20...Qxh2#

20...Qxh2# Mate: queen on h2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on h2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A checking piece next to the king must be protected unless the king cannot capture it for another legal reason.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Checkmate is a complete restriction of the enemy king. Find a legal check, then prove there is no king escape, capture of the checker, or interposition.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect the king's flight squares before choosing a check. A protected queen or a distant rook may cover the last escape in different ways.

The defending king is on h1. Absolute pin: rook on h2.